ALTAGETHER EVENT PLAN

Framing Party



EFFORT: ●○○ COST: ●○○ JOY: ●●●

When one of your neighbors has a framed house, bring people together for a celebratory event to decorate and sign the studs. It's easy to plan, great for kids, and a fun, healing way to mark an important milestone. *"They're really fun, and they're pretty low lift. They kind of just kind of run themselves."* ***~Ellen***

HOW TO PLAN:

2 weeks out

First you need a framed house and enthusiastic "yes!" from the owner.

Work with the homeowner to choose the right date, confirming with their contractor if needed.

1 week out

Send invites to neighbors and encourage the homeowner to invite their own friends and family—this isn't neighbors-only.

Pick up supplies.

Day of

Send a quick reminder if you have time.

Arrive a little early to set up a folding table with markers and drinks.

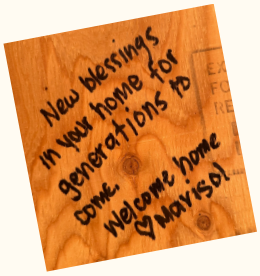
Give people a moment to walk the space before writing. Most need a beat to take it in.

Open the bottle when everyone's gathered.

After

Photograph the signed walls before drywall goes up. Share with Altagether if the homeowner is willing.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED:



- [ ] Colorful markers
- [ ] Champagne
- [ ] Sparkling cider
- [ ] Cups
- [ ] Bottle opener
- [ ] Folding table*
- [ ] A few folding chairs (for folks who can't stand for long periods)*
- [ ] Trash bag

**Altagether can provide—just ask!*

TIPS:

- ✔ Altagether will reimburse for these supplies! Save receipts and submit a request.
- ✔ Get markers that write well on wood, not just standard children's markers.
- ✔ Don't over-program it. Set out the markers, open the champagne, say a few words of welcome, and let people move at their own pace.
- ✔ Some people will write paragraphs. Some will draw a small heart. Don't prompt too much—give people space and they'll find their own words.
- ✔ Let neighbors know that they can come even if they don't know these neighbors well. "Haven't had a chance to meet [name]? This is your opportunity!"

SAMPLE INVITATIONS:

LONG VERSION

Hi everyone! [Name]'s home is being rebuilt, and the frame is up. Before drywall closes the walls in, we're gathering to sign the studs.

Write your name, a message, a hope — whatever you want to say. It'll be sealed inside the walls and be part of that home forever. Neighbors, friends, and family all welcome. Bring the kids.

Markers and refreshments provided.
[Address] · [Time]

SHORT VERSION

Hey neighbors! We're hosting a Framing Party at [Name]'s house this [day] at [time]. The frame is up! Come sign the studs before the walls go in. Neighbors, friends, family, kids all welcome. Markers and refreshments provided.
[Address]

Check out a sample evite for inspiration.

"We had so many neighbors who were still stuck in a permitting process or hadn't even gotten to the permitting process who said that coming to the framing party just **gave them so much hope** and made them feel like, well, if they can get this far, we can get this far too." **~Marisol**